Fantasy Football App User Stories and Acceptance Criteria

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Document Purpose

This document adds testable acceptance criteria to the 29 user stories for the fantasy football recommendation application. A user story is complete only when its listed criteria are satisfied and verified.

Overarching User Story

As a beginner fantasy football player, I want the application to analyze my roster and recommend which players I should start, so that I can set a competitive lineup without needing to understand advanced football statistics or terminology.

Acceptance Criteria Format

The criteria use Given, When, and Then language where it clarifies the setup, action, and expected result. Some criteria use direct statements when a data, reliability, or security condition is easier to test that way.

Roster Integration and User Experience

User Story 1

Requirement	Import and refresh roster and league settings from at least one supported platform.
User Story	*As a fantasy player, I want to import and refresh my league roster automatically so that I do not have to enter every player manually.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. Given valid credentials for a supported platform, when the user connects a league, then the application imports the league settings and every player currently on the user's roster.
2. Given a previously imported league, when the user selects refresh, then roster additions, removals, and league-setting changes appear in the application.
3. Given invalid or expired credentials, when an import or refresh is attempted, then the application does not overwrite the saved roster and displays instructions for reconnecting the league.

User Story 2

Requirement	Support manual roster entry and editing.
User Story	*As a user, I want to manually enter and edit my roster so that I can use the application even when my fantasy platform is unsupported.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. Given a user without a connected platform, when the user searches for and selects NFL players, then those players can be added to the roster and assigned to valid positions.
2. Given an existing manual roster, when the user adds, removes, or changes a player, then the updated roster is saved and remains after the page is reloaded.
3. Given an invalid roster entry, such as the same player entered twice, when the user attempts to save, then the application identifies the problem and prevents the invalid change.

User Story 3

Requirement	Allow users to compare two or more players for a start or sit recommendation.
User Story	*As a beginner fantasy player, I want to compare players so that I can decide who should start in my lineup.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. Given two or more eligible players, when the user starts a comparison, then the application displays each player's relevant recent performance, matchup, injury status, and projected fantasy output.
2. When the comparison finishes, then one player is identified as the recommended starter and the recommendation includes a plain-English explanation.
3. Given players who cannot fill the same lineup position, when the user tries to compare them, then the application explains the eligibility conflict before making a recommendation.

User Story 4

Requirement	Recommend a valid starting lineup from the user's roster.
User Story	*As a fantasy player, I want the application to recommend a complete valid lineup so that I can quickly decide who to start.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. Given a complete roster and league settings, when the user requests a lineup, then the recommendation fills every required starting position with an eligible player from that roster.
2. The recommended lineup does not place the same player in more than one slot and does not exceed the league's position limits.
3. Given that a valid lineup cannot be formed, when the recommendation is requested, then the application identifies each unfilled position and explains what roster information is missing.

User Story 5

Requirement	Provide a plain-English explanation with every recommendation.
User Story	*As a beginner, I want every recommendation explained in plain English so that I understand why it was made.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. When any start or sit recommendation is displayed, then an explanation appears beside it in language intended for a beginner.
2. The explanation identifies at least one factor that affected the recommendation, such as recent performance, matchup, projected opportunity, or player availability.
3. A recommendation cannot be presented as complete if its explanation is missing.

User Story 6

Requirement	Explain football statistics or terminology shown to beginner users.
User Story	*As a beginner, I want unfamiliar football terms and statistics explained so that I can understand the information shown to me.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. When a football abbreviation, statistic, or fantasy term first appears on a page, then the user can open a short definition without leaving the current task.
2. Each definition states what the term means and why it may matter to a lineup decision.
3. If a term has no available definition, then the interface uses its full wording or removes the unexplained term from beginner-facing text.

User Story 7

Requirement	Make the web application usable on desktop and mobile browsers.
User Story	*As a user, I want to access the application from both desktop and mobile browsers so that I can manage my team from different devices.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. Given a current supported desktop browser, when the user imports a roster, compares players, or sets a lineup, then all controls and results remain visible and usable.
2. Given a mobile viewport 360 pixels wide or larger, when the same core tasks are performed, then the page does not require horizontal scrolling and controls do not overlap.
3. Keyboard users can reach and operate the primary navigation, roster controls, comparison controls, and lineup actions in a logical order.

User Story 8

Requirement	Provide clear errors when roster, player, or platform data cannot be retrieved.
User Story	*As a user, I want clear error messages when something cannot be loaded so that I know what went wrong and what I can do next.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. Given a failed data request, when the application cannot load roster, player, or platform data, then it identifies which information failed to load.
2. The message provides an appropriate next action, such as retrying, reconnecting the account, checking entered information, or trying again later.
3. The application preserves data already entered by the user and does not display raw server errors, stack traces, or credentials.

User Story 9

Requirement	Allow a beginner to set a valid lineup in under 3 minutes.
User Story	*As a first-time fantasy player, I want to set my lineup quickly so that managing my team does not require extensive football knowledge or time.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. Given a first-time user with a valid roster already available, when the user begins on the roster screen, then the user can request, review, and accept a valid lineup through one clear workflow.
2. In a usability test, at least 4 of 5 first-time users can complete that workflow within 3 minutes without assistance.
3. The timer begins when the roster screen is ready and ends when the application confirms the saved lineup.

User Story 10

Requirement	Support at least one fantasy football platform integration by release.
User Story	*As a user of a supported fantasy platform, I want my league to connect directly to the application so that I can begin using recommendations without recreating my roster.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. Before release, the application lists at least one supported fantasy platform and provides a working connection flow for it.
2. Given an eligible account on that platform, when the user completes authorization and selects a league, then the league settings and roster are imported without manual player entry.
3. The integration passes tests for initial connection, roster refresh, expired authorization, and a platform service failure.

Player Data and Data Pipeline

User Story 11

Requirement	Automatically retrieve and update NFL player statistics and status information.
User Story	*As a user, I want player information to update automatically so that recommendations are based on current NFL data.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. Given access to the configured NFL data source, when the scheduled update runs, then new player statistics and status information are retrieved without manual entry.
2. After a successful update, the application records the source update time and makes the refreshed values available to the recommendation engine.
3. If retrieval fails, then the failure is logged, existing valid records remain available, and the system marks the data as not refreshed.

User Story 12

Requirement	Store player position, team, fantasy statistics, and injury status.
User Story	*As a fantasy player, I want the system to maintain relevant information about each player so that recommendations can account for their current situation and performance.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. For every stored player, the system can retrieve the player's current NFL team, eligible position or positions, fantasy statistics, and injury or availability status.
2. When the source changes one of these values, then the next successful update replaces the current value while preserving applicable historical statistics.
3. Unknown or unavailable values are stored as missing or unknown rather than as zero or an active status.

User Story 13

Requirement	Update player statistics weekly during the NFL season.
User Story	*As a user, I want player statistics refreshed every week so that my recommendations reflect recent games.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. During each NFL regular-season week, the player-statistics update runs at least once according to the configured weekly schedule.
2. A successful run stores the date, time, NFL season, and week covered by the update.
3. If a scheduled run fails, then the system records the failure and retries or alerts the project team before recommendations for the next week are released.

User Story 14

Requirement	Finish the weekly data update before generating recommendations for the next week.
User Story	*As a user, I want weekly data updates completed before recommendations are produced so that I am not given advice based on outdated information.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. Given that the current week's data refresh is incomplete, when a next-week recommendation is requested, then the system does not label the recommendation as current.
2. Recommendations for the next week are generated only after the pipeline records a successful refresh for the required data period.
3. Each generated recommendation stores or displays the data refresh time used in its calculation.

User Story 15

Requirement	Handle missing or unavailable player data without crashing.
User Story	*As a user, I want the application to continue functioning when some player data is unavailable so that one missing record does not prevent me from using the system.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. Given a player record with one or more missing fields, when the roster or comparison page loads, then the page remains usable and identifies the unavailable information.
2. The recommendation engine either calculates a result using the remaining valid inputs or states that it lacks enough information for that player.
3. One incomplete player record does not prevent other players, rosters, or recommendations from being retrieved.

User Story 16

Requirement	Maintain a unique record for every NFL player.
User Story	*As a system administrator, I want every NFL player to have a unique record so that players are not confused or duplicated within the system.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. Each player record has a stable unique identifier that remains the same when the player's team, position, name formatting, or status changes.
2. When incoming data matches an existing unique identifier, then the existing record is updated instead of creating a duplicate.
3. The data store rejects two active player records with the same source identifier.

User Story 17

Requirement	Include required identifying, statistical, and status fields in each player record.
User Story	*As a recommendation engine, I need each player record to contain the information required for analysis so that recommendations can be calculated consistently.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. Before a player record is marked ready for analysis, it contains a unique identifier, player name, eligible position, NFL team, season, week, required fantasy statistics, and availability status.
2. Records missing a required field are flagged during validation and excluded from calculations that depend on that field.
3. The validation result identifies the player and each missing or invalid field so the data issue can be corrected.

User Story 18

Requirement	Retain historical performance for recommendations and backtesting.
User Story	*As a project team member, I want historical player performance retained so that we can evaluate past performance and improve the recommendation system.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. When new weekly statistics are loaded, then prior weeks are retained instead of overwritten.
2. The project team can retrieve a player's historical statistics by season and week for recommendation analysis or backtesting.
3. A backtest uses only information that would have been available before the historical recommendation time, preventing future data from affecting the result.

User Story 19

Requirement	Associate player statistics with the correct NFL week and season.
User Story	*As a system analyst, I want statistics associated with their correct week and season so that historical and current performances are not mixed together.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. Every weekly statistics record includes both an NFL season and week value.
2. The same player can have only one stored statistics record for a particular source, season, and week unless the record is versioned as a correction.
3. Queries for a specified season and week return only records assigned to that period and do not mix data from other periods.

User Story 20

Requirement	Continue scheduled weekly data refreshes throughout the NFL season.
User Story	*As a user, I want the data pipeline to continue refreshing throughout the season so that the application remains useful every week.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. The weekly refresh schedule remains active for every configured NFL season week, including weeks in which no manual deployment occurs.
2. For each scheduled run, the system records a successful, failed, or skipped status with a timestamp and reason.
3. A monitoring check alerts the project team when a scheduled refresh does not complete successfully within its expected run window.

Recommendation Engine Reliability and Security

User Story 21

Requirement	Provide injury and player-status information when relevant to a recommendation.
User Story	*As a fantasy player, I want recommendations to warn me about injuries or availability concerns so that I do not unknowingly start a player who may not play.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. Given a player with a current injury or availability designation, when that player appears in a recommendation, then the designation and its last update time are shown.
2. When an injury or status creates a meaningful risk that the player may not play, then the explanation includes a visible warning and identifies an eligible alternative when one is available.
3. A player listed as out or otherwise unavailable is not recommended as a starter unless no valid replacement exists, in which case the application explains the roster limitation.

User Story 22

Requirement	Support standard fantasy football scoring formats used by target leagues.
User Story	*As a fantasy player, I want recommendations to account for my league's scoring format so that the advice matches how my league awards points.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. The application supports the scoring formats selected for the target release, including their configured point values and bonuses.
2. Given the same players under different supported scoring settings, when those settings change their expected fantasy points, then the displayed projections and recommendation order are recalculated.
3. The active scoring format is visible before the user accepts a lineup recommendation.

User Story 23

Requirement	Include a one-sentence or two-sentence explanation with each recommendation.
User Story	*As a beginner, I want concise explanations with recommendations so that I can understand the reasoning without reading a lengthy analysis.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. Every displayed recommendation includes an explanation containing one or two complete sentences.
2. The explanation names the recommended choice and at least one relevant reason for that choice.
3. Automated tests fail any recommendation response whose explanation is empty, longer than two sentences, or unrelated to the recommended player.

User Story 24

Requirement	Do not use unexplained fantasy terminology in user-facing explanations.
User Story	*As a beginner, I want recommendations written without unexplained jargon so that lack of football knowledge does not prevent me from understanding them.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. User-facing explanations use full words or provide an accessible definition for each approved fantasy abbreviation or technical term.
2. A content test checks explanations against the project's glossary and flags any unapproved or undefined term before release.
3. When a defined term appears, the user can open its meaning from the recommendation screen without losing the current lineup.

User Story 25

Requirement	Return recommendations within 15 seconds under normal conditions.
User Story	*As a user, I want recommendations generated within 15 seconds so that managing my lineup feels responsive.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. Given a valid roster, available current data, and the normal supported test load, at least 95 percent of recommendation requests return a complete result within 15 seconds.
2. Response time is measured from receipt of the recommendation request until the complete recommendation and explanation are available to the user.
3. If a request exceeds 15 seconds or fails, then the user sees a status or retry message instead of an indefinitely loading screen.

User Story 26

Requirement	Keep the application available throughout the NFL season except during planned maintenance.
User Story	*As a fantasy player, I want the application to remain available throughout the season so that I can use it whenever I need to manage my team.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. During the NFL season, automated health checks confirm that the application can load and accept recommendation requests outside approved maintenance windows.
2. Planned maintenance is recorded before it begins and users receive notice that includes the expected start time and duration.
3. Unplanned outages are logged with their start and recovery times and are not classified as planned maintenance after the fact.

User Story 27

Requirement	Store user roster information securely.
User Story	*As a user, I want my roster and league information stored securely so that my account information is protected.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. Roster and league information is transmitted over HTTPS and stored using the project's approved encryption and access-control configuration.
2. An authenticated user can access only rosters and league information associated with that user's account.
3. Application logs and user-facing errors do not expose platform access tokens, passwords, session secrets, or complete authentication credentials.

User Story 28

Requirement	Use the most recent available player data in the recommendation engine.
User Story	*As a fantasy player, I want recommendations based on the newest available data so that recent performance, injuries, and status changes affect the advice I receive.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. When several valid records exist for a player, the recommendation engine selects the record with the latest applicable source timestamp for the requested week.
2. Each recommendation records or displays the data timestamp used so the project team can verify its freshness.
3. If the newest required data is unavailable or older than the project's freshness limit, then the user is warned before relying on the recommendation.

User Story 29

Requirement	Include a beginner-friendly explanation with 100 percent of recommendations.
User Story	*As a beginner, I want every recommendation to explain its reasoning so that I never have to blindly follow the application's advice.*

Acceptance Criteria

1. Across lineup, player-comparison, and individual start or sit results, every recommendation includes a nonempty beginner-facing explanation.
2. A release test reviews all supported recommendation response types and passes only when 100 percent contain an explanation that identifies the recommendation and a supporting reason.
3. If the explanation service fails, then the application reports that the recommendation is unavailable rather than displaying an unexplained result.